

June 1, 2026

Pia Maria Damonte — Principal
Reseda Charter High School Science Magnet (LAUSD)
18230 Kittridge St, Reseda, CA 91335
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(818) 758-3600

Dear Principal Damonte,

I am applying for the Algebra 1 and Geometry teaching position at Reseda Charter High School Science Magnet for the 2026-2027 school year. I bring a BSc in Mathematics and Computer Science from Brown, fifteen years as a software engineer at Apple, Cisco, and Goldman Sachs, and five years founding and teaching at Dragon and Crane Dojo — a small private school I built from the ground up. I am turning toward LAUSD because I want to spend the next phase of my work in a public school classroom serving the families I most want to serve.

Algebra 1 and Geometry are the gates students either pass through or quietly get stuck at, and a science magnet is exactly the place where getting stuck is most costly. I want to be the teacher who refuses to let those courses become exits from STEM — especially for students who have already self-selected into a science track. The instinct comes from real work: I have watched bright students lose confidence to a single bad year in middle school, both in the off-the-mat curriculum I write and teach at my dojo and in mentoring junior engineers across four companies. The technical depth helps too — geometry showed up daily in the network and infrastructure work I did at Apple and Cisco, and I can show students what their proofs look like once they grow up.

That industry background also lets me answer the question every math student eventually asks — when am I going to use this? I have used it: settlement systems at Goldman Sachs, network management APIs at Apple, clinical AI infrastructure at Deep6 AI. Math was not preparation for those jobs; it was the substance of them, and I want Reseda magnet students to hear that from someone who has lived inside the answer.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can best serve Reseda's students and families.

Sincerely,

David Chung
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